RFP SCORING · AUDIT WORKSHEET

Five RFP Scoring Terms Decide the Winner. *The PBM Knows Your Methodology.*

Three audit passes. One scoring methodology. Adjust before the RFP goes out.

This handout pairs with the Thursday LinkedIn post decoding the five RFP scoring terms (weighted scoring, baseline normalization, financial vs. non-financial split, scenario pricing, tiebreaker hierarchy). Run the three audit passes on the methodology your broker proposes BEFORE sending the RFP — the scoring methodology is the most consequential design decision in the renewal process.

01 Weight the scoring categories against your priorities

Pull the scoring methodology your broker or consultant proposed. List the categories: financial terms, clinical programs, reporting capability, account team, technology, references. Assign weights.

Compare to your internal priority document. If financial is 70% but reporting matters most, the scoring will not surface the right winner.

02 Normalize the financial scoring to net cost equivalents

PBM proposals are not directly comparable: different MAC lists, rebate methodologies, fee structures. Without baseline normalization, the lowest-headline-pricing proposal can be the highest net cost contract.

Run all proposals through a single net-cost-equivalent comparison framework before scoring.

03 Build three scenarios into the financial score

Static pricing favors the proposal engineered for the snapshot. Build three scenarios: current claims mix, projected next-year mix (specialty drift), stress scenario (high-cost claimant cluster, biosimilar shift, formulary exclusion impact).

Score each PBM against all three. The proposal that wins static may rank third under stress.

04 The Pattern PBS Sees Most Often

> **Across approximately 100 PBM contract reviews and audits annually at PBS:** most RFP scoring methodologies score against headline pricing, not normalized net cost. The PBMs know this; the headline number is engineered to win the RFP, not to match what the plan will actually pay.

05 Paste-Ready: Send to Your Broker or PBM

WEIGHTING WORKSHEET · DISCUSS WITH YOUR BROKER

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Category                              Default     Adjusted
  Financial Terms ....................... 70%       ___ %
  Clinical Programs ..................... 10%       ___ %
  Reporting Capability .................. 5%        ___ %
  Technology Platform ................... 5%        ___ %
  References / Account Team ............. 10%       ___ %
                                         -------    -------
  TOTAL ................................. 100%      100%

Financial-only sub-categories (within the Financial Terms weight):
  Static current-mix pricing ............ ___ %
  Projected mix (specialty drift) ........ ___ %
  Stress scenario ....................... ___ %
                                         -------
  TOTAL ................................. 100%

Tiebreaker hierarchy (in order):
  1. _________________________________
  2. _________________________________
  3. _________________________________
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06 This Quarter's Action Plan

STEP 1 · BEFORE RFP DRAFTING

Document the internal priority list

Convene the benefits committee. Produce a one-page priority document that ranks financial, clinical, reporting, and member-experience priorities for the renewal.

STEP 2 · DURING RFP DESIGN

Adjust weights to match priorities

Use the worksheet above. Push back on broker defaults that don't match priorities.

STEP 3 · DURING SCORING

Apply baseline normalization

Convert all PBM proposals to net-cost-equivalents before scoring financial terms.

STEP 4 · BEFORE FINALIST SELECTION

Run scenario stress

Score finalists against current-mix, projected-mix, and stress scenarios. The proposal that wins all three is your winner; if no proposal wins all three, the tiebreaker matters.